

Course Policy Contract

The following policy are designed to best support your learning experience. Please feel free to reach out to the instructor for any concerns during the first week of the semester so we can discuss potential adjustments. Suggestions received after the first week will typically be considered for the next semester, unless an immediate change is necessary.

Behavior Policy: The instructor is committed to create an inclusive and collaborative classroom atmosphere that fosters learning. Please contribute by being positive, respectful and constructive with one another in this class.

1. Any form of plagiarism will result in an "F" grade and will be referred to the University Academic Integrity Committee for further action and determination of consequences.
2. Do not use mobile phones in class for any reason. Do not use laptops while the instructor is lecturing. If you must use them, please step outside the classroom. Each violation will lead to 1 points deducted directly from your final grade.
3. Usually if you do not receive a response to an important email within two work days, you want to resend the email, or speak with the instructor after class.
4. It is your responsibility to regularly check the course materials, announcements, and other updates through Canvas.
5. All class materials, including exam papers, are not allowed to be shared with others or posted online. Any violations may result in a failing grade or potential legal consequences.
6. To encourage free expression, please do not record class lectures in any way, including audio or video recordings unless you have the written permission from the instructor. Any violations may result in a failing grade and potential legal consequences.
7. If you have personal concerns or questions about the class, or if you have a personal request that you would like the instructor to consider, please feel free to first discuss it with the instructor after class via office meeting or email. The instructor prefers not to address individual requests in a public setting.
8. If you have any news related to your learning and career, e.g., received an internship offer, or a job offer, you are welcomed to share it with the instructor.

Attendance Policy: The instructor understands and empathizes with the various challenges we may face in life and is committed to supporting everyone in navigating through uncontrollable circumstances.

1. It is your responsibility to obtain any information missed, including deadlines, from your classmates or the instructor, due to your absence or lateness of any reason.

2. Impact of absences on grades:

- Each instance of arriving late or leaving early will count as 0.5 absences unless excused. Being absent from the classroom for more than 10 minutes but less than half of the class time will be considered a late or early leave. Absence from the classroom for more than half of the class time will be counted as a full absence.
- At the end of the semester, for the first unexcused absence, 0 point toward your final grade will be deducted; For the **second absence, 1 point** will be deducted; For the **third absence, 2 points** will be deducted. The deduction will continue to increase following this pattern by **multiplying 2 of the previous deductions. Missing 7 unexcused classes will result in an "F" as $0+1+2+4+8+16+32=63$ points.**
- Your final grade will be the "Total" shown on the canvas minus the attendance deduction. For example, at the end of the semester, you got 95% in terms of "Total" percentage, however, you have 7 unexcused absences, that will lead to a $93-(0+1+2+4+8+16+32)=37$, which is an F, rather than A.
- For the sake of your own learning, **you must withdraw and retake this class if you miss 8 or more classes, regardless of whether the absences are excused or unexcused**, otherwise you will get an "F" grade. The only circumstance in which you will receive a regular grade is when your total earned grade (except in-class quizzes) ranks the top 25% of the class at the end of the semester.

3. Absence Excuse Policies:

- All excusable absences must be supported by third-party evidences. Otherwise it will not be excused.
- All explanations regarding attendance must be communicated to the instructor via email as a record **before** that class. Otherwise it will not be excused.
- In emergencies that prevent prior notification, you must inform the instructor within one day after the emergency, together with the justification of why this is an emergency and you could not provide notification before the class. Otherwise it will not be excused.

- You're responsible for routinely check your Attendance Roll Call on canvas to ensure the record accurately reflect your status in this class. No changes will be made after two weeks of that absence.
 - All decisions regarding excused or unexcused absences will be determined at the end of the semester.
4. **Attendance Exception:** If your total grade, including the midterm, final exam, assignments, and term project, ranks the top 25% of the class at the end of the semester, your attendance points deducted might be waived (not guaranteed!) by the instructor if "exceptional" performances have been demonstrated during the semester. The instructor has the final authority to decide whether your performance is "exceptional" or not.

Grade Policy: The instructor is dedicated to supporting every student's success in this class. While everyone is unique, the effort students put in and the progress they make throughout the course will be recognized.

1. You may discuss assignments with your classmates, but you must complete the solutions on your own. Any submissions that are inappropriately similar will be considered plagiarism, and all parties involved will face consequences.
2. All student solutions must remain consistent with our course context. Any solution that falls outside this context will not receive credit, even if it might be considered "correct" in a broader sense.
3. Late work, including in-class activities, assignments and exams, will not be accepted unless this is permitted by the instructor **before** the deadline. **In-class activities and exams will not accept any make-ups unless permitted in advance.**
4. The midterm exam is a closed-book assessment. Calculators, class notes, and any other materials will not be permitted. You may only bring a pen to take the exam. For the final exam, you may bring a cheat sheet to the exam. If you miss the exam due to excusable circumstances, you may be given a make-up exam with entirely new questions. The difficulty level of the make-up exam may vary, and your grade will reflect your performance on that exam.
5. You may request a regrade for the entire submission. Once exam papers/submissions have been returned, individual corrections will not be made. Post-return content corrections will be considered only if the same issue affects at least three students. Arithmetic or point-addition errors will be corrected whenever identified.

6. If a grade curve is deemed necessary, it will be implemented at the end of the semester based on all the graded work.

Table 1: General Rubrics Used by the Instructor for Evaluating Solutions to Questions in Assignments, Exams, and Other Student Work

Category	Quality			
	Exemplary (90-100%)	Proficient (80-90%)	Developing (60-80%)	Needs Improvement (0-60%)
Completeness (30%)	The solution fully addresses all parts of the question. It demonstrates a comprehensive understanding of the problem requirements.	The solution addresses most parts of the question but may omit minor details.	The solution addresses some aspects of the question but leaves out critical components.	The solution is incomplete and fails to address key aspects of the question.
Accuracy (30%)	All calculations, reasoning, and conclusions are correct, with no errors.	Minor errors are present but do not significantly affect the overall correctness of the solution.	Several errors are present, which impact the correctness of the solution.	The solution contains major errors and demonstrates a lack of understanding of the topic.
Clarity and Organization (20%)	The solution is well-organized, logically structured, and easy to follow. Steps are clearly outlined, and explanations are provided where needed.	The solution is generally clear and organized but may have minor lapses in logic or structure.	The solution lacks clarity and organization, making it difficult to follow at times.	The solution is poorly organized and unclear, making it challenging to understand.
Use of Concepts and Methods (15%)	Demonstrates an in-depth understanding of relevant concepts and applies appropriate methods effectively.	Shows a good understanding of concepts and applies mostly appropriate methods, with minor inconsistencies.	Demonstrates a basic understanding of concepts but applies methods inconsistently or incorrectly.	Fails to demonstrate an understanding of relevant concepts and methods.
Originality and Critical Thinking (5%)	Solution includes creative insights, innovative approaches, or critical analysis that adds depth to the response.	Some evidence of creativity or critical thinking, but not consistently applied.	Limited evidence of originality or critical thinking.	Lacks originality and critical thinking, relying solely on rote memorization or copied approaches.

Students are responsible for demonstrating and persuading the instructor of the quality of their submissions regarding each of the categories outlined here.

I hereby confirm that I fully understand and acknowledge the policy outlined in the syllabus as fair and reasonable. I agree to comply with these rules throughout the semester and accept full responsibility for any consequences resulting from failure to do so.

Signature:

Date:

Please do not sign it and discuss with the instructor if you do not agree the policy above.